

RetPack Portal Manual

How distributors report empty keg returns, and how the ABI team validates them into SAP. Written for the Phase A/B build on placeholder fields and demo data, after the first design pass.

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01 What the portal is

RetPack is where a distributor tells ABI: *"we are sending empty kegs back, here are the details, here is the paperwork."*

- A **customer** (one of about 50 distributors in Europe) fills in one form per return shipment, attaches the delivery note as a PDF, and submits it.
- The **ABI internal team** (three people) sees every submitted request in a queue, corrects anything wrong, and presses **Validate**. That releases the request to SAP, where a return order is created automatically.
- The customer can follow the request afterwards: whether it has been validated, and the credit-note outcome once it exists.

The portal deliberately does **not** judge whether a request is commercially correct. It checks that mandatory fields are filled and that formats are right, for example that a container number has ten digits. Business correctness is the internal team's job, helped by ABI's existing AI cross-check that reads the attached PDFs.

There are exactly three screens: two for customers, one for the internal team. Keeping it that small is a deliberate cost decision, not a gap. The menu in the dark sidebar switches between them; below it you see who you are signed in as and your role.

02 Who sees what

Customer

Your sign-in email is mapped to one or more customer accounts (payer / sold-to numbers).

New Request

My Requests

Internal (ABI team)

Your email is on the internal-user list. You see every account.

Request Queue

You never choose your role and never type your email into the portal. Identity comes from the platform sign-in, on every page load. A customer only ever sees their own accounts' requests. Requests that are not yours behave exactly as if they did not exist.

If your email is not mapped to anything you see: *"Your account is not provisioned for the RetPack portal. Contact your ABI representative."* That is expected for new users until ABI adds the mapping.

Demo mode

When the portal runs locally or on demo data, the sidebar has a **Demo Mode** panel at the bottom with a yellow *identity is not verified* notice and a **Demo user** drop-down. Pick a user to see the portal as them.

DEMO USER	ROLE	ACCOUNTS
anna@northsea-distribution.example	Customer	A1, A2

DEMO USER	ROLE	ACCOUNTS
bram@rhine-logistics.example	Customer	B1
carla@baltic-bev.example	Customer	C1
ops1@abi.example , ops2@abi.example	Internal	all

The demo set contains eleven requests in every possible state, including one with an unreadable (scanned) PDF and one that SAP rejected.

03 Customer: New Request

Sidebar → New Request. Four steps, in this order.

1 Pick the account

In the **Customer Account** card at the top, choose the **Account** the return belongs to. If your email is mapped to several accounts you will see them all. The SKU list further down depends on this choice, which is why it sits outside the form.

2 Fill in the form

The form is grouped into cards, one per section, two fields per row. Mandatory fields are marked with *; drop-downs show *Select...* until you choose.

SECTION	FIELDS	RULES
Account	SKU, Sales organisation	SKU is mandatory and limited to the 4–5 packaging types of the chosen account. Sales organisation is optional; the ABI team fills it if left blank.
Shipment	Container number, Seal number, Bill of lading number, Destination, Pickup date	Container number: exactly 10 digits. Bill of lading and pickup date are mandatory. Destination is a fixed list.
Quantities	Quantity (kegs), Gross weight (t)	Quantity is mandatory, 1 to 10 000. Weight is optional, two decimals.

SECTION	FIELDS	RULES
Notes	Remarks	Free text, up to 2 000 characters.

3 Attach documents

One upload box per document type: **Delivery note** (one PDF) and **Other supporting document** (up to three).

- PDF only. The portal checks the file content, not just the name.
- At most 25 MB per file. No duplicate files.
- A **scanned** PDF (a photo or scan with no selectable text) is accepted, but you get a warning after submitting: the automated cross-check cannot read it, so the request takes the manual route.

4 Submit

Press **Submit Request**.

- If something is wrong you get a red box *"Please correct the following and submit again"* with one line per problem, for example *Container number: must match ^\d{10}\$*. Nothing is saved; your other entries are kept.
- If everything is accepted you get a **Request Submitted** card with the **reference** (the last 12 characters of the request id, such as `4C1FDB8E7D32`), a green confirmation, any PDF warnings, and read-only cards with what you sent and the documents.

From this moment the request is with the ABI team. You cannot edit it yourself; if you notice a mistake, contact ABI and they will correct it in the queue. Press **Start Another Request** to clear the form.

04 Customer: My Requests

Sidebar → **My Requests**.

Keg balance

At the top, one number per account: the kegs ABI has shipped to you minus the kegs you have returned, as calculated by ABI. Hover the number to see shipped, returned and the as-of date. There is no drill-down by design; for detail, ask your ABI contact.

Request list

COLUMN	MEANING
Reference	Short id, the same one shown at submission
Account, SKU, Quantity	From your form
Submitted	Date and time (UTC)
Status	Not validated waiting for the ABI team · Validated released to SAP
Credit note	Number of the credit note once ABI has issued it

Customers only ever see these two statuses. Whatever happens between "validated" and the credit note (SAP order numbers, shipment numbers, retries) is internal.

Open a request

Pick a reference in **Open request** to see the full read-only detail: a status badge, the credit-note line, and two tabs, **Details** (current values, including any corrections the ABI team made) and **Documents** (page count and whether the text was readable).

05 Internal team: Request Queue

Sidebar → **Request Queue**. This is the only internal screen. Three tiles at the top show how many requests are waiting for review, being sent to SAP, and needing attention.

The list

The **Status** filter defaults to Submitted, which is your work queue: everything customers have sent and nobody has validated yet. Statuses are shown with these labels; the technical codes in brackets appear in logs and in the data contract.

STATUS	MEANING
Submitted SUBMITTED	Waiting for review
Validated VALIDATED	Released; the SAP job picks it up within minutes

STATUS	MEANING
Sending to SAP CPI_PENDING	Being sent to SAP, or a temporary SAP error is being retried
SAP order created CPI_DONE	SAP return order created
Needs attention CPI_FAILED	SAP rejected it or retries ran out. Needs a person (see dead letters below)
All	Everything

The table shows reference, account, customer email, SKU, quantity, submission time, status, number of PDFs and how many of those are unreadable scans.

Open a request

Pick a reference in **Open request**. A card opens with the reference, account, customer, submission time and **version** number in its header, a status badge, and any outcome messages (credit note, SAP return-order number, or the SAP error). Below are tabs:

1. **Details:** the values table with four columns: field, current value, the customer's original value, and a Yes marker where they differ.
2. **Documents:** filename, type, pages, size, readable text yes/no; per document **Prepare** and then **Download**. Two clicks on purpose: only one file at a time is held in memory on the shared server.
3. **Corrections:** who changed which field from what to what, and when. This log is permanent.
4. **Actions** (only while the request can still be edited): correct a field, validate.

Correct a field

In the **Actions** tab under **Correct a field**: choose the field, enter the new value (the right widget appears: text, number, date or drop-down), press **Save Correction**.

- The same format rules apply as for the customer; a nine-digit container number is refused here too.
- The customer's original value is never lost. It stays in the original column and in the change log.
- The **Account** field cannot be changed. A request on the wrong account has to be resubmitted.

- Blank the value to clear an optional field.

Validate

Press **Validate and Release to SAP**. The portal re-checks all mandatory fields on the current values first. If one is still empty the validation is refused with the reason; fill it in and try again.

After a successful validation the status filter switches to **All** so the request stays on screen with its new status. The SAP handoff job runs every few minutes and moves the status to *Sending to SAP*, then *SAP order created* or *Needs attention*.

"This request was changed by someone else"

Two team members can work in the queue at the same time. Every action is checked against the **version** you saw when you opened the request. If a colleague changed it in between, your action is refused with this message and the screen shows the latest version. Read it and repeat your action if it is still needed. Nothing is ever silently overwritten.

Dead letters

Filter on **Needs attention** to see requests SAP rejected (for example *CPI 400 unknown sold-to*) or that failed three times on temporary errors. These are the only requests, besides SUBMITTED ones, you can still edit: correct the offending field and press **Validate** again. The job retries with a fresh idempotency key, so SAP does not create a duplicate order.

06 Life of a request

flowchart LR

```
A[Customer submits] --> S[SUBMITTED]
S -->|team corrects fields| S
S -->|Validate| V[VALIDATED]
V -->|job calls SAP via CPI| P[CPI_PENDING]
P -->|order created| D[CPI_DONE]
P -->|temporary error, retry| P
P -->|rejected or 3 failures| F[CPI_FAILED]
F -->|team corrects and validates again| V
D -->|credit note issued| C[Credit note shown to customer]
```

Customer sees **Not validated** for SUBMITTED

Validated for everything from VALIDATED onward plus the credit-note number when it exists

07 What happens behind the scenes

- **Nothing is ever overwritten.** Every action is a new entry in an append-only log: the submission with its original values, each correction with old and new value and who made it, the validation, every SAP attempt and its result, the credit note. The screens are calculated from that log. It is also the audit trail ABI needs.
- **Documents** are stored as-is in a Databricks Volume, in a folder per account and request. The portal reads only two cheap facts from them, page count and whether there is selectable text, and hands them untouched to ABI's AI cross-check.
- **SAP** is never called while you wait. Validation only marks the request; a background job picks it up, calls the existing CPI endpoint, retries temporary failures up to three times, and records the outcome.
- **Access checks** happen on every request in two independent places: in the database queries, which can only ever return the signed-in customer's accounts, and in the document store, which only opens files for an account the signed-in user belongs to.

08 Rules and limits at a glance

TOPIC	RULE
Sign-in	Platform identity; email must be mapped by ABI
Editing after submit	Customers: never. Team: while Submitted or Needs attention
Mandatory fields	Enforced at submit and again at validate
Formats	Per field (digits, dates, drop-down membership); everything else is free text
Documents	PDF only, checked by content; 25 MB per file; 1 delivery note + up to 3 others; no duplicates
Scanned PDFs	Accepted with a warning
Customer statuses	Not validated / Validated, plus credit note
Concurrency	Version check; conflicting actions are refused, never merged

09 Running it

WHERE	HOW
Deployed dev app	retpack-portal on Azure Databricks (https://retpack-portal-1283361390446220.0.azure.databricksapps.com). Sign in with your Databricks account; your email must be on the internal list or mapped to an account.
Locally, in-memory demo	<code>make run-mock</code> then <code>http://localhost:8501</code> . Data resets on every start.
Locally, persistent demo	<code>make run-sqlite</code> . Data survives restarts in <code>.retpack/</code> .

Local runs always show the demo user switcher.

10 Troubleshooting

YOU SEE	WHY	WHAT TO DO
<i>Your account is not provisioned</i>	Your email is not mapped to an account or the internal list	Ask ABI to add it (production) or pick a demo user (local)
<i>Please correct the following...</i>	A field broke a rule; nothing was saved	Fix the listed fields, submit again
<i>Request not accepted: not a PDF / unreadable PDF</i>	The file is not a real PDF or is damaged	Export it again as PDF and retry
<i>... has no text layer</i> (yellow)	Scanned PDF; the request is saved	Nothing required; the ABI team handles it manually
<i>This request was changed by someone else</i>	A colleague acted on it first	Review the latest version, repeat if still needed
<i>request is CPI_PENDING; only ...</i>	You tried to edit a request that is with SAP	Wait for <i>SAP order created</i> or <i>Needs attention</i>
<i>Something went wrong ... reference XXXXXXXX</i>	Unexpected error; details are in the server log under that reference	Retry; report the reference if it persists

11 Glossary

TERM	MEANING
Account / payer / sold-to	The customer number in SAP a return belongs to
SKU	Packaging type: 50 L keg, 30 L keg, 20 L keg, slim keg, pallet
Reference	Last 12 characters of the request id, shown everywhere
Version	Number of entries in the request's log; used for the conflict check
Validate	The team's release action; triggers the SAP return order
CPI	SAP Cloud Integration, the existing endpoint that creates return orders
Dead letter	A request SAP rejected or that failed repeatedly; needs a person
Credit note (CN2)	ABI's financial outcome for a completed return

12 What will change

- **Fields:** the real ~30 fields from the ABI mapping file replace the placeholder set. Sections, labels and rules are configuration, so the screens stay the same.
- **Document types:** the real list and how many of each.
- **Status names:** ABI's official names replace the placeholders; customers still see only validated / not validated.
- **Look and feel:** the first design pass is in: dark menu sidebar, copper accent, cards, status badges in the colours used on this page. The logo is a placeholder until the real brand files replace the images in `assets/`.